



Family Trait Detectives

Grade 1 Life Science • Parents & Offspring Unit • Lesson 1 of 6



Grade 1



40–50 minutes



NGSS 1-LS3-1



Household materials

FAMILY SCIENCE FILE #1

**Notice the core pattern:
young plants and animals
are like their parents, but
not exactly the same.**

**Big idea: Offspring usually share traits with
their parents, and each offspring still has its
own mix of traits.**



Look for parent-offspring clues: shared traits, differences, and survival supports.

Student does

observe • sort • draw • explain

Evidence focus

shared traits + differences

Family win

short, visual, printable

NGSS 1-LS3-1: Make observations to construct an evidence-based account that young plants and animals are like, but not exactly like, their parents.



Learning Objectives

- Observe parent-offspring pairs and name at least two shared traits.
- Use evidence words: same, similar, different, trait, offspring.
- Make a simple claim: the offspring is like the parent but not exactly the same.



Materials

What You Need

- Family photos are optional; animal/plant photos from books, packaging, or online images work too
- Mirror
- Paper, crayons, scissors if making cards
- Two different leaves from the same kind of plant if available

No special kit: substitute photos, drawings, toys, or household objects freely.



Vocabulary

Trait

A feature you can see, such as fur color, leaf shape, eyes, stripes, or height.

Offspring

A young plant or animal from a parent plant or animal.

Similar

Alike in some ways.

Not identical

Not exactly the same.



Parent Read-Aloud Background

Scientists do not start by guessing. They start by looking carefully. In this unit, your student becomes a family-pattern detective. The mystery is simple but powerful: why do babies, seedlings, chicks, kittens, and children look like their parents without being perfect copies?

A trait is a feature you can observe. A kitten may have whiskers, four legs, fur, and pointed ears like an adult cat. It may also be smaller, fluffier, or a different color. A sunflower seedling may have green leaves and a stem like the adult plant, but it is shorter and has no flower yet. The pattern is not “exactly the same.” The Grade 1 science idea is better: like, but not exactly like.



Activity Procedure

Step 1 — Open the mystery file

Show two parent-offspring pairs: one animal and one plant if possible. Ask, “What clues tell us these go together?”

Step 2 — Make trait cards

On small slips of paper, draw or write traits: fur, feathers, leaves, stem, eyes, legs, stripes, spots, height, color, shape.

Step 3 – Sort evidence

Place trait cards beside each pair. Put shared traits in the middle and difference traits to the side.

Step 4 – Mirror or photo option

If the family wants, repeat with a child and parent photo or a mirror. Keep it gentle: “What features are similar?” not “Who do you look like most?”

Step 5 – Say the science claim

Student completes: “The offspring is like the parent because _____. It is not exactly the same because _____.”



Discussion Questions

Question 1: What is one trait the parent and offspring share?

Accept any observable trait: both have fur, both have leaves, both have four legs, both have a similar body shape.

Question 2: What is one way the offspring is different?

Younger, smaller, different color, missing an adult feature, shorter stem, fewer leaves.

Question 3: Why is “exactly the same” not the best science answer?

Because offspring share some traits with parents, but each young plant or animal has differences too.

Question 4: Can we use plant evidence in the same idea?

Yes. Young plants can share traits with parent plants, such as leaf shape or stem type, but they are not adult-sized copies.



Parent Notes

Keep it Grade 1: The target is observation and evidence, not genetics vocabulary beyond simple inherited traits. If a family situation makes human comparisons sensitive, use animal and plant examples only. The science standard is fully met without personal family photos.



Student Worksheet — Family Trait Detective File

Name: _____ Date: _____

1) Trait Evidence Table

Pair	Shared trait evidence	Different trait evidence
Animal pair		
Plant pair		
Optional family/photo pair		

2) Draw One Pair

Parent	Offspring

Science sentence: The offspring is like the parent because _____. It is not exactly the same because _____.

Parent answer-key guidance: Look for one shared trait and one real difference for each pair. Strong answers point to observable evidence, not guesses.



Baby-to-Adult Growth Gallery

Grade 1 Life Science • Parents & Offspring Unit • Lesson 2 of 6

Grade 1

40–50 minutes

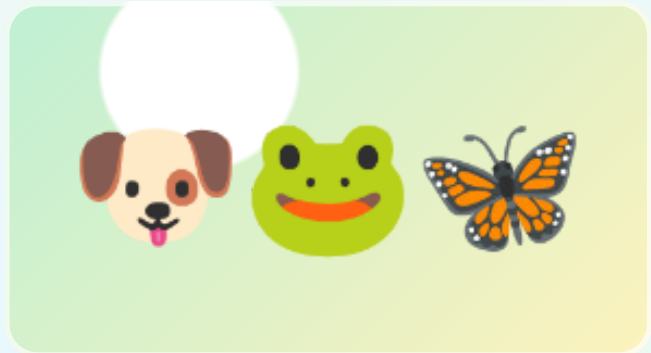
NGSS 1-LS3-1

Household materials

FAMILY SCIENCE FILE #2

Compare several animal offspring to their adults and separate inherited traits from growth changes.

Big idea: Young animals often have the same body plan as adults, but their size, color, covering, or body parts may change as they grow.



Look for parent-offspring clues: shared traits, differences, and survival supports.

Student does

observe • sort • draw • explain

Evidence focus

shared traits + differences

Family win

short, visual, printable

NGSS 1-LS3-1: Make observations to construct an evidence-based account that young plants and animals are like, but not exactly like, their parents.

Learning Objectives

- Match baby animals with adult animals using observable trait evidence.
- Tell the difference between an inherited trait and a growth change.
- Compare a same-shape growth example with a big-change example such as a frog or butterfly.



Materials

What You Need

- Animal photos/cards from books or printed images
- Paper folded into four boxes
- Crayons or colored pencils
- Optional: toy animals or stuffed animals

No special kit: substitute photos, drawings, toys, or household objects freely.



Vocabulary

Adult

A fully grown plant or animal.

Body plan

The main body parts an animal has.

Growth change

A change that happens as a young organism grows.

Evidence

A clue you can point to and explain.



Parent Read-Aloud Background

Lesson 1 built the big pattern. Lesson 2 makes it stronger by looking across more animals. Some babies are easy to match to adults. A puppy has legs, fur, eyes, and a tail like a dog. A duckling has a beak, wings, and webbed feet like a duck. They are smaller, fuzzier, and not ready to do everything adults do.

Some animals change dramatically. A tadpole does not look much like an adult frog at first, and a caterpillar looks very different from a butterfly. That does not break the pattern. It gives students a richer version: offspring belong to the same kind of organism, but young stages can look very different from the adult stage.



Activity Procedure

Step 1 — Build the gallery

Choose four animal families: cat/kitten, duck/duckling, frog/tadpole, butterfly/caterpillar. Draw or place pictures in pairs.

Step 2 — Find match clues

For each pair, ask, “What clue tells us these belong together?” For frog and butterfly, use life-stage clues if body traits are very different.

Step 3 — Mark inherited traits

Circle traits the young animal already has from its kind: feathers, beak, fur, legs, body shape, or later-stage pattern.

Step 4 — Mark growth changes

Star traits that change with growth: size, fuzz to feathers, tail loss in frogs, wings after chrysalis.

Step 5 — Make a gallery label

Student writes or dictates one evidence sentence for each pair.



Discussion Questions

Question 1: Which baby animal was easiest to match to its adult? Why?

Likely kitten/cat or duckling/duck because visible body traits are similar.

Question 2: Which one changed the most?

Frog or butterfly examples; tadpole/frog and caterpillar/butterfly show big stage changes.

Question 3: Does a big change mean the offspring is unrelated to the adult?

No. It means that organism has life stages. It is still the same kind of animal.

Question 4: What evidence should a scientist use?

Observable traits and growth-stage clues, not just guessing from cuteness or size.



Parent Notes

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Student Worksheet — Baby-to-Adult Growth Gallery

Name: _____ Date: _____

1) Growth Gallery

Animal family	Clue it belongs together	What changes as it grows?
Kitten → cat		
Duckling → duck		
Tadpole → frog		
Caterpillar → butterfly		

Word bank: smaller • fuzzier • legs • wings • tail • body shape • same kind

2) Circle and Explain

Which animal changes the most? kitten / duckling / tadpole / caterpillar

My evidence:

Parent answer-key guidance: Accept growth changes such as smaller size, fuzzy covering, tadpole tail/legs/gills, caterpillar to butterfly wings. The strongest answer names the evidence clue.



Parent Care Survival Stations

Grade 1 Life Science • Parents & Offspring Unit • Lesson 3 of 6

Grade 1

40–50 minutes

NGSS 1-LS3-1

Household materials

FAMILY SCIENCE FILE #3

Explain how adults help offspring survive by meeting needs.

Big idea: Many animal parents help offspring survive by giving food, warmth, protection, transport, or shelter.



Look for parent-offspring clues: shared traits, differences, and survival supports.

Student does

observe • sort • draw • explain

Evidence focus

shared traits + differences

Family win

short, visual, printable

NGSS 1-LS3-1: Make observations to construct an evidence-based account that young plants and animals are like, but not exactly like, their parents.



Learning Objectives

- Name common needs of young animals: food, water, warmth, shelter, and safety.
- Match parent-care behaviors to the need they help meet.
- Use cause-and-effect language: “This helps the offspring survive because...”



Materials

What You Need

- Towel or blanket
- Small bowl/spoon
- Paper nest materials: scrap paper, cotton balls, leaves, yarn, or tissue
- Toy animal or crumpled-paper “baby animal”
- Crayons

No special kit: substitute photos, drawings, toys, or household objects freely.



Vocabulary

Survive

Stay alive and keep growing.

Need

Something living things must have to live.

Protect

Keep safe from danger.

Shelter

A safe place to rest or grow.



Parent Read-Aloud Background

Offspring are not just small adults. Many young animals cannot find enough food, stay warm, or avoid danger on their own. Animal parents can change the offspring’s chance of survival by caring for them.

Care is not one single behavior. A bird feeds chicks. A penguin warms a chick. An alligator carries hatchlings to water. A fox guards a den. These are different actions with the same science purpose: helping offspring live long enough to grow.



Activity Procedure

Step 1 — Set up four stations

Make quick stations labeled by action: feed, warm, protect, shelter. Use objects instead of buying materials.

Step 2 — Act and match

Student moves the toy baby animal through each station and says what the parent is doing.

Step 3 – Build a shelter

Use paper/towel/scraps to build a nest or den that protects the “baby” from a pretend wind or bump.

Step 4 – Connect action to need

For each station, fill the sentence: “The parent ____ so the offspring can ____.”

Step 5 – Choose best evidence

Ask: “Which care action would matter most for a baby bird? Which for a baby turtle? Why might answers differ?”



Discussion Questions

Question 1: Why do many babies need more help than adults?

They are smaller, weaker, still growing, and may not yet find food or protect themselves.

Question 2: Is parent care only cuddling?

No. Parent care can be feeding, warming, guarding, carrying, shelter-building, or teaching later.

Question 3: How does shelter help offspring survive?

It can hide them, block weather, and keep them close to the parent.

Question 4: Do all animals give the same amount of care?

No. This lesson focuses on animals that do care. Other species use many eggs/offspring or other strategies.



Parent Notes

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Student Worksheet — Parent Care Survival Stations

Name: _____ Date: _____

1) Survival Station Match

Parent action	Need it helps	How it helps survival
Feeds offspring		
Warms offspring		
Protects offspring		
Builds or uses shelter		

2) Design a Safe Place

Draw a nest, den, pouch, or safe place for offspring.

This helps offspring survive because...

Parent answer-key guidance: Food, warmth, protection, and shelter are all survival supports. Student should connect action to need: “warming helps the baby stay alive because it cannot keep itself warm yet.”



Watch, Practice, Learn

Grade 1 Life Science • Parents & Offspring Unit • Lesson 4 of 6

 Grade 1

 40–50 minutes

 NGSS 1-LS3-1

 Household materials

FAMILY SCIENCE FILE #4

Separate born-ready behaviors from skills young animals learn by watching and practicing.

Big idea: Some behaviors are built in, and some survival skills improve when offspring watch, follow, and practice with adults.



Look for parent-offspring clues: shared traits, differences, and survival supports.

Student does

observe • sort • draw • explain

Evidence focus

shared traits + differences

Family win

short, visual, printable

NGSS 1-LS3-1: Make observations to construct an evidence-based account that young plants and animals are like, but not exactly like, their parents.

Learning Objectives

- Sort behaviors into “born ready” and “learned/practiced.”
- Explain how following or watching parents can help offspring find food or avoid danger.
- Use evidence from a simple practice challenge to describe learning.



Materials

What You Need

- Spoon and small soft object such as pom-pom, sock ball, or cotton ball
- Two cups or bowls
- Paper path or tape line
- Crayons
- Optional: short nature video clip of young animals following adults

No special kit: substitute photos, drawings, toys, or household objects freely.



Vocabulary

Behavior

Something an animal does.

Instinct

A behavior an animal is born ready to do.

Learned behavior

A behavior that improves with watching, teaching, or practice.

Practice

Trying again to get better.



Parent Read-Aloud Background

Lesson 3 showed direct care. Lesson 4 adds a different kind of help: learning. Some behaviors happen without teaching. A baby bird opens its mouth for food. A newborn mammal may search for milk. Those are born-ready behaviors.

Other skills improve by watching and practice. Ducklings follow adults to food and safe water. Young otters learn food-handling tricks. Lion cubs practice stalking and pouncing through play. Parents do not pass these skills the same way they pass body traits. They help offspring survive through behavior and experience.



Activity Procedure

Step 1 – Try the practice challenge

Move a soft object from one cup to another using a spoon. Do three trials. Count drops.

Step 2 – Notice improvement

Ask whether trial 3 was easier than trial 1. That is practice evidence.

Step 3 – Sort animal behaviors

Use cards or oral examples: chick begging, duckling following, cub play-stalking, spider spinning web, young otter copying tool use.

Step 4 – Make the parent-help link

For learned/practiced cards, ask, “How does watching or following an adult help survival?”

Step 5 – Write the claim

Student completes: “Some behaviors are born-ready, but ____ gets better with practice.”



Discussion Questions

Question 1: What is one behavior a young animal may be born ready to do?

Beg for food, cry/call, suck milk, follow movement in some species, or hatch/move.

Question 2: What is one behavior that may need watching or practice?

Hunting, finding safe food, using tools, flying well, social calls, avoiding danger.

Question 3: How is learning different from inheriting a body trait?

A body trait is passed from parents. A learned behavior improves through watching, teaching, and practice.

Question 4: Why does practice help survival?

The offspring gets better at getting food, moving safely, or avoiding danger.



Parent Notes

Keep it Grade 1: The target is observation and evidence, not genetics vocabulary beyond simple inherited traits. If a family situation makes human comparisons sensitive, use animal and plant examples only. The science standard is fully met without personal family photos.



Student Worksheet — Born Ready or Learned?

Name: _____ Date: _____

1) Sort the Behaviors

Behavior	Born ready?	Learned/practiced?	Evidence clue
Baby bird begs for food			
Duckling follows parent to water			
Otter learns food-handling trick			
Cub practices pouncing			

2) My Practice Evidence

Trial 1 drops	Trial 2 drops	Trial 3 drops	Did practice help?

Learning helps offspring survive because...

Parent answer-key guidance: Born-ready examples can include begging/calling/sucking. Learned/practiced examples should include a clue about watching, following, trying again, or improving.



Seeds Are Plant Offspring

Grade 1 Life Science • Parents & Offspring Unit • Lesson 5 of 6

 Grade 1

 40–50 minutes

 NGSS 1-LS3-1

 Household materials

FAMILY SCIENCE FILE #5

Integrate plants into the same unit arc: seeds are offspring, and parent plants prepare them for survival.

Big idea: Plants do not cuddle or teach, but parent plants make seeds with structures that help young plants start life and sometimes travel.



Look for parent-offspring clues: shared traits, differences, and survival supports.

Student does

observe • sort • draw • explain

Evidence focus

shared traits + differences

Family win

short, visual, printable

NGSS 1-LS3-1: Make observations to construct an evidence-based account that young plants and animals are like, but not exactly like, their parents.



Learning Objectives

- Identify seeds as plant offspring.
- Compare a seed/seedling with its parent plant using traits.
- Explain how seed coats, stored food, fruit, hooks, wings, or fluff can help plant offspring survive.



Materials

What You Need

- Kitchen seeds: dry bean, apple seed, popcorn kernel, sunflower seed, or any safe seed available
- Fruit with seeds if available
- Paper towel and small cup/bag for optional sprout start
- Magnifying glass optional
- Crayons

No special kit: substitute photos, drawings, toys, or household objects freely.



Vocabulary

Seed

A young plant package made by a parent plant.

Seed coat

The outside covering that protects a seed.

Stored food

Food inside many seeds that helps the young plant start growing.

Disperse

Move away from the parent plant.



Parent Read-Aloud Background

The old weak version of this idea can feel random if plants appear as an afterthought. In this rebuild, plants are the proof that the parent-offspring pattern is bigger than animal babies. A seed is not a rock or a snack to the plant. It is a young plant package from a parent plant.

Plants cannot follow their offspring, warm them, or teach them where to grow. Instead, parent plants prepare seeds before they leave. Some seeds have hard coats. Some have food inside. Some are inside fruits that animals carry. Some float, stick, spin, or parachute away. The survival job is real, just different from animal care.



Activity Procedure

Step 1 — Open a seed investigation

Look at two or three seeds. Compare size, shape, color, coat, and whether they came from a fruit, pod, cone, or flower.

Step 2 — Draw seed evidence

Student draws one seed large and labels coat, inside food if visible, and travel clue if present.

Step 3 – Parent plant match

Ask, “What kind of parent plant could this seed come from?” Use apple/apple tree, bean/bean plant, sunflower/sunflower.

Step 4 – Travel test model

Blow gently on paper “seeds,” roll a round seed, or stick a paper seed to a sock. Which travels best?

Step 5 – Plant the unit claim

Student says: “A seed is plant offspring. It is like its parent because _____. It is not exactly the same because _____.”



Discussion Questions

Question 1: Why does a plant lesson belong in a parent-offspring unit?

Because seeds and seedlings are young plants from parent plants, and they show the same like-but-not-identical pattern.

Question 2: How can a seed coat help survival?

It protects the young plant package until conditions are better for growing.

Question 3: Why might a seed need to travel away?

To find space, light, water, and soil without too much competition from the parent plant.

Question 4: How is plant “parent help” different from animal care?

Plants prepare seed structures ahead of time instead of feeding, guarding, or teaching after birth.



Parent Notes

Keep it Grade 1: The target is observation and evidence, not genetics vocabulary beyond simple inherited traits. If a family situation makes human comparisons sensitive, use animal and plant examples only. The science standard is fully met without personal family photos.



Student Worksheet — Seed Survival Detective

Name: _____ Date: _____

1) Seed Detective Table

Seed	Parent plant	Protection clue	Travel clue
Apple seed / fruit seed			
Bean / pea / pod seed			
Dandelion / fluffy seed / paper model			

2) Draw a Seed Package

Seed up close 	Where it might grow 
---	--

A seed is plant offspring because...

Parent answer-key guidance: Seeds count as plant offspring. Good evidence names seed coat/protection, stored food, fruit/animal travel, wind travel, hooks, rolling, or floating.



Parent-Offspring Evidence Case

Grade 1 Life Science • Parents & Offspring Unit • Lesson 6 of 6

 Grade 1

 40–50 minutes

 NGSS 1-LS3-1

 Household materials

FAMILY SCIENCE FILE #6

Capstone: build an evidence-based explanation across animals and plants.

Big idea: Scientists use observations as evidence to explain a pattern: young plants and animals are like, but not exactly like, their parents, and many adult behaviors or structures help offspring survive.



Look for parent-offspring clues: shared traits, differences, and survival supports.

Student does

observe • sort • draw • explain

Evidence focus

shared traits + differences

Family win

short, visual, printable

NGSS 1-LS3-1: Make observations to construct an evidence-based account that young plants and animals are like, but not exactly like, their parents.

Learning Objectives

- Use evidence from at least one animal and one plant example.
- Build a claim-evidence-reasoning explanation at a Grade 1 level.
- Explain how a parent behavior or seed structure helps offspring survive.



Materials

What You Need

- Completed worksheets from Lessons 1-5
- Blank paper or notebook
- Crayons
- Scissors/glue optional for evidence collage
- Three sticky notes or scrap-paper evidence cards

No special kit: substitute photos, drawings, toys, or household objects freely.



Vocabulary

Claim

What you think is true.

Evidence

The observations that support the claim.

Reasoning

Explaining how the evidence proves the claim.

Pattern

Something that happens again and again.



Parent Read-Aloud Background

The capstone should not introduce a brand-new idea. It should make students use the ladder they built: observe traits, compare growth, connect care to survival, distinguish learned behavior, and include plant offspring.

A strong Grade 1 explanation can be oral, drawn, or written with help. The key is evidence. “They are cute” is not evidence for the standard. “The duckling and duck both have beaks and webbed feet, but the duckling is smaller and fuzzier” is evidence. “The seed coat protects the seed” is evidence about survival support.



Activity Procedure

Step 1 – Choose two cases

Pick one animal parent-offspring pair and one plant parent-offspring pair from earlier lessons.

Step 2 – Make evidence cards

Create three cards: shared trait, difference, survival help.

Step 3 – Build the case poster

Draw or glue the pairs. Place evidence cards around them.

Step 4 – Say claim-evidence-reasoning

Use the frame: “I claim _____. My evidence is _____. This shows _____.”

Step 5 – Family share

Student teaches the pattern to someone else in the house in under one minute.



Discussion Questions

Question 1: What is the unit’s biggest science pattern?

Young plants and animals are like, but not exactly like, their parents.

Question 2: What evidence did you use for an animal?

Shared trait plus a difference, or a parent-care/learning behavior that helps survival.

Question 3: What evidence did you use for a plant?

A seed/seedling trait plus a seed structure such as coat, stored food, fruit, fluff, hooks, or wings.

Question 4: What would make an explanation stronger?

Pointing to observable traits and explaining how care/structures help survival.



Parent Notes

Keep it Grade 1: The target is observation and evidence, not genetics vocabulary beyond simple inherited traits. If a family situation makes human comparisons sensitive, use animal and plant examples only. The science standard is fully met without personal family photos.



Student Worksheet — My Evidence Case Poster

Name: _____ Date: _____

1) My Evidence Cards

Evidence card	My observation
Shared trait	
Not exactly the same	
Survival help	
Plant evidence	

2) Evidence Case Poster

Draw one animal case and one plant case. Add arrows to your evidence.

My claim: Young plants and animals are like, but not exactly like, their parents.

My evidence:

My reasoning:

Parent answer-key guidance: Capstone is successful when it includes animal evidence, plant evidence, a shared trait, a difference, and one survival support explanation.



Parents & Offspring

GRADE 1 LS3 QUICK REFERENCE

1. Like, Not Copies

- Offspring share traits with parents.
- They are similar, not identical.
- Use evidence you can see.

2. Growth Changes

- Young animals may be smaller or fuzzier.
- Some change body form as they grow.
- Adult traits can appear later.

3. Animal Parent Care

- Parents may feed, warm, carry, guard, or shelter young.
- Some young learn by watching and practicing.
- Care helps offspring survive.

4. Plant Offspring

- Seeds are young plant packages.
- Seed coats, stored food, fruit, fluff, hooks, or wings help survival.
- Seedlings are like parent plants, but not adult copies.

Claim: Young plants and animals are like their parents.

Evidence: Name shared traits and differences.

Reasoning: Traits, care, and seed structures help survival.

NGSS 1-LS3-1 • Little Lab Coats • Parent-Offspring Evidence Words: trait • offspring • similar • different • survive



Parents & Offspring Quiz

Grade 1 • Life Science • Unit 2

QUESTION 1

A seedling and its parent bean plant both have green leaves, but the seedling is much smaller. What pattern does this show?

Young plants are exactly the same as parents

Young plants are like, but not exactly like, parent plants

Seeds are not living things

Only animals have offspring

QUESTION 2

Which observation is the best evidence that a kitten is related to an adult cat?

It is cute

It has fur, whiskers, ears, and a cat body shape

It sleeps a lot

It fits in a box

QUESTION 3

A duckling is fuzzy and small. An adult duck has smoother feathers and is larger. What changed?

The kind of animal

Growth traits such as size and covering

The duck became a plant

Nothing changed

QUESTION 4

A bird feeds chicks in a nest. Which need is the parent helping meet?

Food

Reading

Color

Counting

QUESTION 5

A penguin keeps a chick warm. Why does that matter?

Warmth can help the chick survive

It changes the chick into a fish

It teaches spelling

It makes the chick identical to the parent

QUESTION 6

A young otter watches an adult and practices opening food. What kind of behavior is improving?

A learned or practiced behavior

A body trait like eye color

A seed coat

A rock behavior

QUESTION 7

Which is a plant offspring?

A spoon

A seed

A bird nest

A shadow

QUESTION 8

How can fruit help seeds?

It can get animals to carry seeds away

It teaches seeds to read

It makes seeds into adults immediately

It makes all seedlings identical

QUESTION 9

Which sentence is the strongest science claim?

Baby animals are cute

Offspring are like their parents because they share traits, but they are not exactly the same

Parents are always bigger

Plants are random

QUESTION 10

For the capstone, which evidence set is strongest?

One animal trait, one plant seed trait, one difference, and one survival help

Only a favorite animal

Only a drawing with no explanation

A guess about who is cutest

Parents & Offspring Unit Quiz Answer Key

Little Lab Coats • Grade 1 • Parent/Teacher Copy

1. A seedling and its parent bean plant both have green leaves, but the seedling is much smaller. What pattern does this show?

Answer: B. Young plants are like, but not exactly like, parent plants

The key LS3 pattern includes plants: young plants can share traits with parent plants and still be different.

2. Which observation is the best evidence that a kitten is related to an adult cat?

Answer: B. It has fur, whiskers, ears, and a cat body shape

Observable traits make stronger evidence than opinions.

3. A duckling is fuzzy and small. An adult duck has smoother feathers and is larger. What changed?

Answer: B. Growth traits such as size and covering

Offspring can keep the same animal identity while changing as they grow.

4. A bird feeds chicks in a nest. Which need is the parent helping meet?

Answer: A. Food

Feeding helps young animals survive and grow.

5. A penguin keeps a chick warm. Why does that matter?

Answer: A. Warmth can help the chick survive

Many young animals need adult help with warmth and safety.

6. A young otter watches an adult and practices opening food. What kind of behavior is improving?

Answer: A. A learned or practiced behavior

Watching and practice are clues for learned behavior.

7. Which is a plant offspring?

Answer: B. A seed

A seed is a young plant package made by a parent plant.

8. How can fruit help seeds?

Answer: A. It can get animals to carry seeds away

Fruit can help seed dispersal when animals carry or drop seeds.

9. Which sentence is the strongest science claim?

Answer: B. Offspring are like their parents because they share traits, but they are not exactly the same

A strong claim names the pattern and uses trait evidence.

10. For the capstone, which evidence set is strongest?

Answer: A. One animal trait, one plant seed trait, one difference, and one survival help

The unit goal is evidence across animals and plants.